The poems

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Answer all seven questions in English. Use complete sentences.
Base your answers on the poems. You may refer to the texts on this page.

The Road Not Taken

Robert Frost

Two roads diverged in a yellow wood,
And sorry I could not travel both
And be one traveler, long I stood
And looked down one as far as I could
To where it bent in the undergrowth;

Then took the other, as just as fair,
And having perhaps the better claim,
Because it was grassy and wanted wear;
Though as for that the passing there
Had worn them really about the same,

And both that morning equally lay
In leaves no step had trodden black.
Oh, I kept the first for another day!
Yet knowing how way leads on to way,
I doubted if I should ever come back.

I shall be telling this with a sigh
Somewhere ages and ages hence:
Two roads diverged in a wood, and I—
I took the one less traveled by,
And that has made all the difference.

Count That Day Lost

George Eliot

If you sit down at set of sun
And count the acts that you have done,
And, counting, find
One self-denying deed, one word
That eased the heart of him who heard,
One glance most kind
That fell like sunshine where it went—
Then you may count that day well spent.

But if, through all the livelong day,
You've cheered no heart, by yea or nay—
If, through it all
You've nothing done that you can trace
That brought the sunshine to one face—
No act most small
That helped some soul and nothing cost—
Then count that day as worse than lost.

Poem texts: Academy of American Poets American Literature

Questions 1-4

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

1. The Road Not Taken

Where is the speaker, and why can he not travel both roads?

Write 1-2 complete sentences.

2. Count That Day Lost

Give TWO examples of kind actions from the first stanza that can make a day well spent.

Write 1-2 complete sentences.

3. The Road Not Taken

The second road first seems different. What does the speaker later notice about BOTH roads? Explain your answer using TWO details from the poem.

Write 3-4 complete sentences.

4. Count That Day Lost

Why does the poet call a day with no kindness "worse than lost"? Explain what we miss when we do nothing for others.

Write 3-4 complete sentences.

Questions 5-7

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

5. The Road Not Taken

Describe a real or imagined choice between two options. Explain how choosing one option could close another opportunity. Connect your example to the speaker's doubt that he will ever come back.

Write 4-5 complete sentences.

6. Count That Day Lost

A student says, "I cannot make someone's day better because I have no money." Do you agree? Explain using a detail from the poem and an example from school life.

Write 4-5 complete sentences.

7. Both poems

Compare the two poems. What does each poem suggest about our choices or actions? Give ONE detail from EACH poem to support your answer.

Write 4-5 complete sentences.